

A

Reason

I went home early **because** I was feeling tired.

As/Since I was feeling tired, I went home early. (We don't usually start a sentence with *because*.)

I was feeling tired, **so** I went home early. (This is very common in spoken English.)

The reason I went home early **was that** I was feeling tired.

We can also use **because of** with a different construction. Compare:

They go there **because** the weather is wonderful. (because + noun + verb)

They go there **because of** the wonderful weather. (because of + (adjective) + noun)

Due to means the same as **because of**, and is often used to explain the reason for a problem.

The plane was late **due to** bad weather. (**Due to** is often used after the verb *be*.)

Common mistakes

It's a pity you can't go on holiday **because** Chiclayo is very nice. (NOT It's a pity you can't go on holiday ~~because of~~ Chiclayo is very nice.)

We moved house **because of** my father's work. (NOT We moved house ~~because~~ my father's work.)

B

Purpose

A **purpose** is an intention or reason for doing something.

The **purpose of** the meeting is to plan next year's timetable. [the reason *for* the meeting]

We often introduce a purpose using **so (that)** or **(in order) to**:

I bought this book **so (that)** I **could** improve my English.

They went home early **(in order) to** watch the match on television.

We moved house **so (that)** we **could** send our children to this school.

She went into town **(in order) to** do some shopping.

C

Result

These link words/phrases are used when one thing happens because another thing has happened. **Therefore** and **as a result** are more formal than **so**, and less common in spoken English.

I left my ticket at home, **so** I had to buy another one.

They've got more money, and **therefore** they can afford to buy the best football players.

I forgot to send the email. **As a result**, no one knew about the meeting.

D

Conditions

We sometimes use **whether** [if] when we are not sure about something.

I didn't buy it because I wasn't sure **whether** you'd like it.

I spoke to the others, but I don't know **whether** they're coming.

We'll be late **unless** we leave now. [if we don't leave now]

Unless the weather improves [if the weather doesn't improve], we won't be able to go.

I have to go now, **otherwise** [because if I don't] I'll miss the last bus.

You'll have to turn up the music, **otherwise** [because if you don't] they won't be able to hear it.

You can borrow it **as long as** you bring it back by Thursday. [but you *must* bring it back]

You can wear what you like **as long as** you look quite smart. [but you *must* look quite smart]

I'm taking my umbrella **in case** it rains. [I'm doing A because B might happen later.]

Take some money **in case** you need to get a taxi.

Exercises

94.1 Rewrite the sentences using *because of*. Make any necessary changes.

- 1 I couldn't play because my arm was broken. *I couldn't play because of my broken arm.*
- 2 Teresa got the job because her exam results were good.
- 3 The weather was terrible, so we couldn't eat outside.
- 4 As she had a cold, she didn't go to school.
- 5 The light was bad, so the referee stopped the game.
- 6 The traffic was terrible; I was late.
- 7 He's only 17, and therefore he can't vote.

94.2 Complete the sentences.

- 1 I must write that letter now, *otherwise* I'll forget to do it.
- 2 I'll take some sandwiches with me I get hungry.
- 3 We agreed to buy my daughter a dog she takes it for a walk every day.
- 4 I left early miss the rush-hour traffic.
- 5 My girlfriend didn't feel very well, we left the party quite early.
- 6 there's a problem, I won't disturb you.
- 7 You can borrow my dictionary you bring it back on Monday.
- 8 You'd better tidy your room, your mother will be angry.
- 9 I sent Luiza an invitation, but I don't know she's coming.
- 10 The I didn't ring you was that I'd lost your phone number.

94.3 Complete the memo.

ReplyForward

ToAll Staff

FromDaniel Myers

SubjectTemporary roadworks

CCBCC

09 August

From next Monday, the council are closing both approach roads to the factory. The ¹ of this, I believe, is to install new gas pipes. ² this will create long delays, could I please ask staff to leave home a few minutes early in the morning ³ everyone gets here on time. The roadworks also mean that you won't be able to park on the street, and ⁴ it may be a good idea to leave your cars at home ⁵ it is absolutely impossible for you to use public transport.

I haven't been told ⁶ the roadworks will continue for the whole week, but I will let you know as soon as possible, and I apologise for the inconvenience.

Daniel Myers
Office manager

94.4 Over to you

Complete the sentences in a way that is true for you.

- I want to improve my English because
- I don't know whether my English
- I often need to write words down, otherwise I
- I don't get many opportunities to practise my English, therefore
- Speaking English may be important in order to